

Day 2 setup: get the new files and connect to the model

Today your project gets new files: the two Day 2 exercises, the database tables for the triage agent, and `app/llm.py`, which connects the agent to a language model. In this setup you download them, rebuild the database, and check that the model answers.

If you get stuck, note the step number and the exact error message, and ask a facilitator.

What you need

- The **same laptop** as on Day 1, with the project in `C:\Users\<your name>\course\agentic-coding-intro`
- The model **key** from the facilitator

Setup 1 · Save your Day 1 work

1. Open **VS Code** with the project folder (**File** → **Open Recent** → **agentic-coding-intro**).
2. Open a terminal: **Terminal** → **New Terminal**. The path should end in `agentic-coding-intro>`.
3. Save everything you did on Day 1 as a commit:

```
git add -A; git commit -m "Day 1 done"
```

It's fine if this says *"nothing to commit"*: then your work is already saved.

4. Check which branch you are on:

```
git branch --show-current
```

You should see your own branch, e.g. `my-work`. If it says `main`, ask a facilitator before you continue.

Setup 2 · Download the Day 2 files

Download what's new on GitHub. This doesn't change any of your files yet:

```
git fetch
```

Then choose **one** of these two:

A. Continue with your own Day 1 work. Choose this if your tip form and `/editor` page work.

```
git merge origin/main --no-edit
```

B. Start fresh from the reference solution. Choose this if your Day 1 app doesn't work, or if option A shows a *conflict*. Your Day 1 work stays safe on your own branch.

```
git merge --abort  
git switch -c my-day2-work origin/day1-solution
```

only if option A showed a conflict

Check that the new files arrived. In the Explorer on the left, you should now see `exercises/day2-exercise1.md`, `exercises/day2-exercise2.md` and `app/llm.py`.

Setup 3 · Rebuild the database

The triage agent needs two new tables. Run the setup script again:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\setup.ps1
```

It ends with **All good!**, as on Day 1. It also resets the database to the sample tips, so tips you submitted yourself on Day 1 are gone. That's expected.

Setup 4 · Connect to the model

On Day 2 you build a **triage agent**: a small program that reads tips and asks a language model what they are about. GitHub Copilot is your *coding* agent; the triage agent is a separate program with its own access to a model, in **Microsoft Foundry**.

The agent needs a **key**: a password for the model. You save it once, in a file in your own user folder, **outside the project**. Run these two lines. The second one asks for the key: paste the key from the facilitator and press Enter.

```
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Force $HOME\.tip-portal | Out-Null
Read-Host "Paste the key" | Set-Content -NoNewline $HOME\.tip-portal\key.txt
```

The key is now in `C:\Users\<your name>\.tip-portal\key.txt`.

Then check that the model answers:

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python -m app.check_model
```

You should see something like:

```
Model:      gpt-5-nano
Answered in 2.4 s, tokens used: 281
Tool call:  get_desk_list  (tool calling works)
```

Why not in the project's .env? Remember Day 1 step 4a: Copilot read `.env` and put its contents in the chat. Copilot's file tools only look inside the project folder; to read a file outside it, Copilot has to ask you first. And this project tells VS Code to always ask before Copilot runs a command that reads a file, such as `Get-Content` or `cat`.

So: **if Copilot ever asks to open or read `.tip-portal\key.txt`, say no.** It never needs the key itself. The key is only for your triage agent.

✓ You're ready when

- ☐ Your Day 1 work is committed, and you are on your own branch (`my-work` or `my-day2-work`)
- ☐ You can see `exercises/day2-exercise1.md` and `exercises/day2-exercise2.md`
- ☐ `setup.ps1` ended with **All good!**
- ☐ `python -m app.check_model` says **tool calling works**

Continue with exercise 1: your AGENTS.md.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
<code>git commit</code> says <i>"Please tell me who you are"</i>	Run the two <code>git config</code> commands from the Day 1 setup, then commit again
<code>git merge</code> says CONFLICT	Run <code>git merge --abort</code> , then use option B (start fresh). Your Day 1 work stays on your own branch
<code>git switch</code> says <i>"a branch named 'my-day2-work' already exists"</i>	You already did option B. Run <code>git switch my-day2-work</code> instead
<code>fatal: invalid reference: origin/day1-solution</code>	Run <code>git fetch</code> first, then try again
<code>[FAIL] No model key found</code>	The key file is missing. Run the two key lines from Setup 4 again
The model service answered 401	The key is wrong or has a typo. Run the Read-Host line again and paste it once more
The model service answered 404	Ask a facilitator
Could not reach the model service	The network may block the model service. Ask a facilitator
did not answer in JSON	Ask a facilitator
Warning: the model did not call the tool	Ask a facilitator